Shelbie Torok
December 18, 2019

"What right has such a scoundrel to be honored by a top-supported institution of learning?"[1]: Student Activism, Campus, and the Community

On January 4, 1971, Eastern Michigan University (EMU) graduate student Arthur R. Herez sent a note to EMU Regent Virginia Allan stating he was "[...] greatly disappointed in the selection of Julian Bond as the commencement speaker and the decision to award him an honorary degree."[2] Herez wrote a letter to EMU in protest of the selection of Julian Bond as the speaker and recipient of an honorary Doctor of Laws degree at Eastern Michigan University's January 17, 1971 commencement. Herez was not alone in expressing his discontent with University Administration. F. Lawrence Badgley, a Michigan resident from Benton Harbor, protested in letters to EMU Regents Edward McCormick and Dr. Charles Anspach. Badgley noted, "the selection could only be from sheer ignorance or a planned purpose to make this Republic and its citizens Communist Slaves."[3] These Michigan residents protested the selection of a speaker who was a key member in the Civil Rights Movement, especially regarding student protests in the 1960s and 1970s. Student activism erupted on college campuses in the 1960s, and changed campus climate through the 1970s as *Brown V. Board* took effect and legislation such as the Civil Rights Act of 1964 was passed. Eastern Michigan was no different. Students at Eastern Michigan protested in February 1969, demanding a list of grievances. Students wished for the appointment of a person holding the title Vice President of Minority Affairs, and that this person

[1] E. Winfred Brown to Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[2] Arthur R. Herez to Virginia R. Allan, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[3] Lawrence Badgley to Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

be black. They wished for a Black Studies program to be started at the university, to "be totally controlled by blacks." Another demand was charging tuition based on family income. Students wished for a section in the library dedicated to art and literature by black people, and that all history courses include the roles of black people. Additionally, they demanded for "a large amount of black students from the Ypsilanti area be admitted" to EMU, as well as that Martin Luther King and Malcom X scholarships be created, with a board comprised of black people. Students also demanded a board to hear complaints of teacher prejudice, that athletic scholarships not be withheld due to injury, a black co-ed dormitory, and that "no action be taken against those students" who participated in the demonstration.[4] Over a year later, those protests still had an impact on Eastern and the surrounding community in Michigan. In January 1971—as the campus was still roiling from the protests—EMU decided to give Julian Bond an honorary degree. In response to this decision, EMU received over 230 letters in protest of Julian Bond speaking at the January 17, 1971 commencement and receiving an honorary degree. These letters protested Bond's appearance, accused him of being Communist, anarchist, and anti-American, nonetheless the University Honorary Degree Committee decided to host him as speaker and bestow him with an honorary Doctor of Laws.

The student activism movement in the 1960s and 70s has been discussed by historians since the events were fresh in the headlines. Martha Biondi presents a succinct social history of the national student activism movement, pointing out that "student activists forced a permanent change in American life" that transformed "overwhelmingly white campuses into multiracial learning environments." Biondi links student protests to fundamental changes in the educational

[4] Black Student Demands, Harold Sponberg Papers, Box 5, Folder 24. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

system, and displays how the student rose to the forefront of the Black freedom struggle.[5] Jeffrey Turner, in contrast, takes a more regional approach, focusing on student activism in the South, specifically. Turner also takes a biracial approach, choosing to not focus only on the activities of white students in the New Left, but taking into account those by black students as well.[6] Wesley Hogan provides an overview of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC) and the New Left, specifically of how student activism spread. Hogan shows how the SNCC influenced Black student activism in the North and the creation of organizations such as Students for a Democratic Society (SDS).[7] The letters sent to EMU in 1971 represent a backlash from the surrounding community in response to these organizations and instances of Black student activism. Jeff Roche discusses white backlash in the 1960s, noting that white Americans "did not understand" the goals of the Supreme Court, which was pushing for desegregation following *Brown v. Board*, and were concerned for their protection as taxpaying Americans. [8] Michigan residents declared to EMU that they were proud "Michigan taxpaying citizen[s]" who found it to be their "duty to protest the appearance of Julian Bond."[9] The Black activism at Eastern Michigan in 1969 and 1970 clearly spurred a reaction from the university's community that warrants recognition within the historiography of student activism and white backlash to that activism.

---

[5] Martha Biondi, *The Black Revolution on Campus* (Berkley and Los Angeles: University of California Press, 2012), 3.
[6] Jeffrey A. Turner, *Sitting in and Speaking Out* (Athens, Georgia: University of Georgia Press, 2010).
[7] Wesley Hogan, "Freedom Now! SNCC Galvanizes the New Left," in *Rebellion in Black and White*, ed. Robert Cohen and David J. Snyder (Baltimore, Maryland: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 2013), 43–59.
[8] Jeff Roche, "Political Conservatism in the Sixties: Silent Majority or White Backlash?," in *The Columbia Guide to America in the 1960s*, ed. David Farber and Beth Bailey (Columbia University Press, 2001).
[9] Adrian Blauwkamp to Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

Although Bond spoke at EMU in 1971, over a year after the students protested, memories lingered for the university's community. Bond's political activities and views were no secret, and fell directly in line with the student protest movement of the 1960s and 1970s. His speech even mirrored the demands that black students gave to EMU administration in February 1969 during protests that included the occupation of Pierce Hall. Michigan residents were anxious following the student protests on campus, and were fearful of the consequences of honoring Julian Bond, a man many residents saw as revolutionary. The 237 letters sent by the community in protest of Bond solidify the connection between those protests and Bond's appearance on campus.[10]

The climate on college campuses underwent a dramatic shift from the 1960s to the early 1970s, primarily due to the impact of *Brown V. Board of Education*, the Civil Rights Movement, and the passing of the Civil Rights Act of 1964. This shift included the rise of protest organizations such as the SNCC and SDS, as well as protests on college campuses nationwide. The EMU campus was fraught with racial tensions in the late 1960s and early 1970s. Student enrollment grew from about 5,000 in 1960 to almost 20,000 in 1970. As the student body grew, including the number of black students, students began to demand more equal rights for black students on campus.[11]

In February 1969, one protest in particular by Eastern Michigan students made local and state headlines. The headline in the Eastern Echo on Friday, February 21, 1969 read, "Tempers Flare As Marcher, Police Clash." On February 20, 1969, nearly 100 students barricaded themselves inside Pierce Hall and demanded to speak with University President Harold Sponberg

---

[10] Bond, Julian, Commencement Speaker Controversy, Commencement Address, Jan. 17, 1971. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 5. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[11] Report of the Commission to Investigate the Disorders at Eastern Michigan Universityin May 1970, 19, Campus Demonstration Records, Box 2, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

regarding a list of "demands attempting to bring about Black equality at EMU." Police broke through the barricades and placed students under arrest on charges of "conspiracy to create a disturbance." Those students chose to be arrested peacefully, with one student stating, "if we have to go we are going as quiet, peaceful demonstrators, if they want to swing, nobody here will swing back." The arrested students were escorted out of the building, followed by white and black participants who were not arrested. Students also surrounded the President's house and again asked for an audience with President Sponberg. Another group of about 150 students staged a sit-in on the first floor of Pierce Hall later in the day, though this demonstration did not result in any arrests.[12]

In 1970 students protested again. In addition to being fuelled by dormitory issues on campus, the protests that occurred in 1970 were inexplicably related to those in 1969. A report conducted into the 1970 protests concluded that "Although the incident [occupation of Pierce Hall] occurred more than a year prior to the May disorders, there are many who believe that it marks the beginning of the difficulties which culminated in the disorders." In May 1970, a crowd of about 2,000 people defied a curfew in place and blocked a nearly block-long stretch of Forest Ave. The protest of the curfew began with a group of 75 students who demanded the administration meet a list of demands for increased student participation in decision-making at the university and at least 18 percent Black enrollment by 1975, in addition to protesting the killing of students at Kent State University the previous week.[13] In the two years prior to Bond

---

[12] "Tempers Flare As Marchers, Police Clash," Eastern Echo, February 21, 1969. Eastern Michigan University Archives.; "Police Thwart EMU Building Takeover," *Detroit Free Press*, February 21, 1969.

[13] Report of the Commission to Investigate the Disorders at Eastern Michigan Universityin May 1970, 19, Campus Demonstration Records, Box 2, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.; "EMU Under Curfew; 39 Arrested in Protest," *Detroit Free Press*, March 12, 1970.; "EMU Students Defy Curfew," *Detroit Free Press*, March 13, 1970.

being invited to speak and receive an honorary degree in 1971, students at EMU were very clearly participatory in the student activism movement. The protests at EMU in 1970 occurred in part as a response to the massacre at Kent State. The killings at Kent State in Ohio occurred during a protest at that school, and were part of the wider student protest movement, specifically against the war in Vietnam. The war in Vietnam became an important issue for student protest in the late 1960s to early 1970s, however race maintained its place as the primary issue for student protest.[14] Students at EMU became involved in anti-war protests in 1970 through their protest of the killings of students at Kent State University, however race and administrative changes were still the primary factors motivating protests in Ypsilanti.

The letters sent to EMU Regents underscored the relationship between the university and the surrounding Michigan community. Most of the letters contained at least a city name or post office stamp indicating the location of origin, allowing for the letters to be mapped using ArcGIS to gain a spatial understanding of EMU's influence in Michigan, and where the community has a stronger connection to the university. First, the letters were compiled into an excel spreadsheet to organize the data. Then, using ArcGIS, 217 of 237 letters could be mapped, since not all letters contained an address. Each point on the map is accurate to the city name only; they are not exact addresses. Also included in each point is the name of the letter writer, the person to which the letter was addressed, and a quote from the letter of the main point of protest.

An analysis of the spatial distribution of the letters showed that the number of letters being sent from Detroit was more concentrated than in any other part of Michigan. This suggests that the events of the race riots that occurred in 1967 were still fresh in the memories of

[14] Turner, 225-226.

residents. These anxieties had an effect on the relationship between residents in Detroit and EMU, spurring twenty five letters to be written and sent from the city in protest of Julian Bond, someone they saw as revolutionary and fully capable of instigating violence akin to that during the riots.

Additionally, eight different categories were applied to the letters based on the main reasons for protest in each letter. These include: No Reason/Other, Communism, Anarchism, Anti-Americanism, Revolutionary Activities, Leftist Political Ideology, Bond's sponsorship by the Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) and the W.E.B. DuBois Clubs on college campuses, and his potential influence on students and other youth. Multiple categories could be applied to some of the letters, but no more than three categories applied to any single letter. These categories help explain the reasons the community in Michigan protested the selection of Julian Bond, placing EMU within the scope of the student protest movement, and backlash to that movement.

Sixty nine of the 237 letters sent in protest of Bond's appearance at EMU stated reasons related to his actions as a revolutionary. For example, A. H. Stedman II complained in a letter to EMU Regent Lawrence R. Husse, "[Bond] has been an official of the violently militant SNCC, at the same time, has applied for the status of conscientious objector. He was refused a seat in the Georgia legislature because of his pro-Communist attitude on the war in Vietnam; he has publicly accused the United States of being the aggressor in Vietnam."[15] The Department of Michigan, Veterans of Foreign Wars (VFW) chapter also sent their remarks. Commander Robert L. Harrison and Adjutant C. E. Schumacher sent a letter to Regent Virginia Allan that said, "It is

[15] A. H. Steadman II to Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

ironic that a man who advocates revolution should be given such recognition."[16] Bond was a known critic of the war in Vietnam, and was initially denied his seat on the Georgia State Legislature due to his feelings against Vietnam.[17] In his commencement speech, he even referred to the war as the "rape of Vietnam."[18] Bond's known anti-Vietnam and pro-activist views were interpreted by the community in Michigan as opposing "what our morals and national constitution stand for," as Mr. & Mrs. Arthur C. Thede of Grand Rapids wrote.[19] While the Michigan community was supportive of the war, students nationwide and at Eastern were growing skeptical of the conflict; the protests in May 1970 display that clearly, and even more so with Bond's invitation to Eastern in 1971.[20]

In addition to Bond being a revolutionary, he was also accused of being a communist. Elizabeth F. Bontekoe sent a letter to Dr. Charles Anspach from Linden that stated, "His pro-communist revolutionary activities and connections are a matter of record from coast to coast."[21] Sixty two letters, including the one sent by Bontekoe, were sent protesting Bond's supposed communist leanings, associations, and activities. Tensions over the Cold War were still rampant in the United States in the late 1960s, including among the residents of Michigan. Gilbert R. Gregory wrote from Williamston, starkly stating, "we have to do all we can to prevent

---

[16] Robert L. Harrison and C. E. Schumacher, Department of Michigan VFW to Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[17] "Negro Ousted by Georgia House Supported by 23 Congressmen," *The New York Times*, January 13, 1966.
[18] Julian Bond, Commencement Address,, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 5. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan, p. 2.
[19] Mr. & Mrs. Arthur C. Thede to Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[20] Martha Biondi, *The Black Revolution on Campus* (Berkley and Los Angeles: University of California Press, 2012), 24.
[21] Elizabeth F. Bontekoe To Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

the Communist takeover."[22] Due to Bond's supposed Communist leanings, residents also hoped "his speech has been censored," as Mrs. A. M. Bierman wrote from Adrian.[23] Other colleges in the country, including the University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill, instituted a ban on speakers affiliated with the Communist Party over "fears of communist infiltration and threats to white supremacy."[24] Comments such as those sent by Bierman display this fear among the EMU community. A letter from F. Lawrence Badgely, who wrote, "the selection could only be from sheer ignorance or a planned purpose to make this Republic and its citizens Communist Slaves," further illustrates that the EMU community expressed its fears of a communist takeover through the protest of Bond's appearance.[25]

Fears of a communist takeover were not the only source of concern for the EMU community. Michigan residents wrote forty nine letters to EMU regents regarding concerns of anarchy, including Richard Friske, a Representative in the Michigan House of Representatives for Michigan's 106th district. Friske cited Bond's "revolutionary activities and his advocacy of anarchy" as his reason for protest, adding he was "shocked" Bond was also receiving an honorary degree.[26] P. H. MacBride also sent a letter from Brighton that urged, "Anarchists, Radicals, Socialists, and Communists should not be allowed on our campuses."[27] Michigan

---

[22] Gilbert R. Gregory To Dr. Charles Anspach, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[23] Mrs. A. M. Bierman To Dr. Harold Sponberg, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[24] Joy Ann Williamson-Lott, "Student Free Speech on Both Sides of the Color Line in Mississippi and the Carolinas," in *Rebellion in Black and White*, ed. Robert Cohen and David J. Snyder (Baltimore, Maryland: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 2013), 61.
[25] F. Lawrence Badgely to Edward McCormick, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 1. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[26] Richard Friske to Lawrence R. Husse, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 1. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[27] P. H. MacBride to Dr. Charles Anspach. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

residents accused Bond of being an anarchist because he was "all for Black Panthers and demonstrations to stir up violence."[28] Fears of anarchy were rooted in the struggle for Black power, which was a threat to the racial hierarchy promoted on predominantly white campuses.[29]

Related to accusations of communism, fifteen letters included as the main point of protest that Bond was anti-American. Richard H. Smith, Jr.indicated that "all in all, Eastern Michigan would have had much difficulty in selecting a man more pro-communist and un-American than Mr. Bond."[30] Additionally, Patricia Neenan wrote from Detroit, pleading for the regents to "not allow this anti-American to degrade your school with his appearance."[31] Writing from Detroit, just a few years after the horrific events of the infamous race riots in 1967, Neenan and twenty-five other letter writers from Detroit would have had those events fresh in her mind when she wrote this letter. The riots in Detroit had a significant impact on both the state and the country, and fears of a similar incident occurring as a result of racially motivated protests on campus at Eastern were apparent. Another letter from Detroit also made the assumption that EMU would lose some of its reputation with the surrounding community. Paul Neenen wrote, "Please do not have this anti-American degrade your university with his appearance."[32] Being anti-American was heavily associated with communists and anti-war advocates, and indicate that the accusations of Bond being un-American were fueled by the narrative that the civil rights movement was rooted in a communist plot.[33]

---

[28] Mrs. L. O. to Dr. Harold Sponberg. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[29] Williamson-Lott, 62.
[30] Richard H. Smith, Jr. to Lawrence R. Husse. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 1. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[31] Patricia Neenan to Dr. Harold Sponberg. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[32] Paul Neenen to Lawrence R. Husse. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[33] Williamson-Lott, 61.

In addition to protests over Bond's alleged association with Communism and anarchy, letter writers also critiqued Julian Bond's organizational affiliations. For example, the EMU community sent thirty-seven letters that specifically mentioned the SDS and WEB DuBois Clubs as the reason for protest. One note sent by Mrs. Dennis H. Poole claimed that "Bond has been sponsored on many college campuses by the S.D.S., W.E.B. Dubois and other radical groups."[34] Michigan residents, including Phyllis B. Korten, saw these organizations as radical and revolutionary. She expressed her concern by letting Dr. Harold Sponberg know that "He has been sponsored by the militant SDS and the communist DuBois Clubs."[35] Bond's affiliations with these left-wing organizations was daunting to Michigan residents, who saw these groups as radical and revolutionary. On campuses across the country, these organizations were known for being multi-racial, being made up of both black and white students. However, in the later 1960s SDS moved its vision from just societal integration to one of "self-determination" for black lives, black education, and black communities.[36] This shift toward black self-determination by these organizations was frightening to those who wrote to EMU in 1971, and evident in their letters.

About thirteen of the letter writers raised concerns that Bond would have an adverse influence on students at the university, and on youth overall. Mrs. N. Black wrote to Dr. Harold Sponberg expressing her concerns, indicating she would not "wish him to influence students or future teachers of our still younger children."[37] Eastern Michigan has trained teachers since its inception as a school. This complaint is unique to EMU and its community because of this,

---

[34] Mrs. Dennis H. Poole to Lawrence R. Husse. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 1. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[35] Phyllis B. Korten to Dr. Harold Sponberg. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[36] Biondi, 45.
[37] Mrs. N. Black to Dr. Harold Sponberg. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

however it also falls within the purview of a censorship issue related to communism and anarchism. Mrs. N. Black sent an additional complaint pushing censorship of Bond's speech that stated, "Surely he should be barred from influencing our youth - and future teachers."[38] Another concerned Michigan citizen, Mrs. Dale McAllister, also wrote, "Because of his background and affiliation I don't believe he is one to be allowed to speak to our young."[39] These comments were based in concern for youth, and with motivation for censoring content that was unfavorable to some in the university's community.

Finally, letter writers grounded their opposition to Julian Bond in political terms. W. H. DeMattia stated, "The New Left, for which he is a leading spokesman, has no constructive program whatsoever but preaches only revolution and destruction."[40] The New Left was emerging in the late 1960s and early 1970s, and gained much of the insight that allowed it to be successful from the SNCC.[41] With much of Michigan not belonging to the New Left, it is no surprise the emerging political field was the least mentioned in the protest letters. The letters that do mention the New Left, however, also discuss similar concerns as letters that specified revolution or anarchy, such as a letter sent by Richard H. Ichord from Livonia. He expressed his concern regarding "frequent news accounts of inflammatory speeches which were being made to large audiences on college and university campuses by the radical rhetoric of the New Left promoting violence and encouraging the destruction of our system of government."[42]

---

[38] Mrs. N. Black to Dr. Charles Anspach. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[39] Mrs. Dale McAllister to Dr. Harold Sponberg. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[40] W. H. DeMattia to Dr. Harold Sponberg. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 3. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.
[41] Wesley Hogan, "Freedom Now! SNCC Galvanizes the New Left," in *Rebellion in Black and White*, ed. Robert Cohen and David J. Snyder (Baltimore, Maryland: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 2013), 48.
[42] Richard H. Ichord to Virginia R. Allan. Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 2. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan.

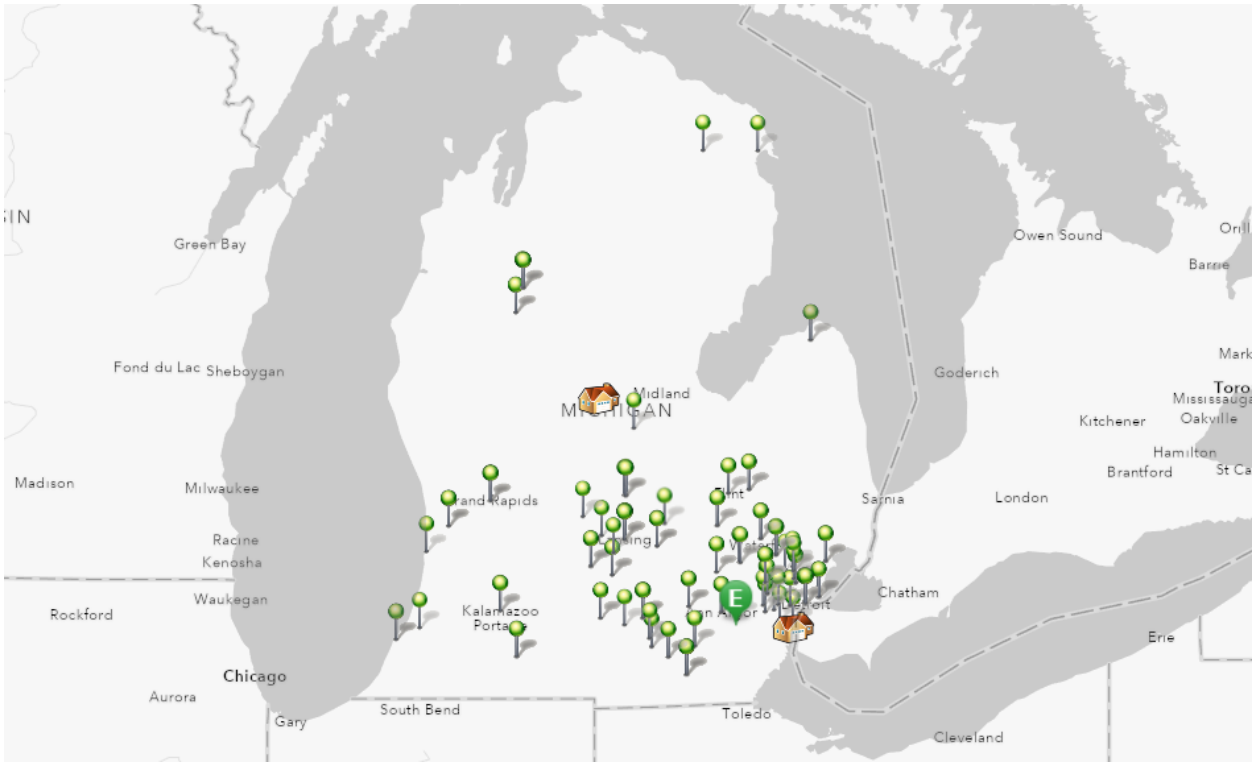
Julian Bond did indeed appear at Eastern Michigan's commencement ceremony on January 17, 1971 as the honored speaker and recipient of an honorary Doctor of Laws, despite 237 letters being fervently written in protest of such an occasion. The reasons for the Michigan community protesting his appearance, recent protests on campus, and the contents of Bond's speech cement the relationship between EMU and the student protest movement. The speech Bond gave at the commencement ceremony mirrors the demands Black students gave during the protests in 1969, as well as the third chapter of a book Bond wrote that was published in 1972 called *A Time to Speak, A Time to Act: The Movement in Politics*.[43] The speech—and the book chapter—directly confronted the issue of student protest by white students and by black students, and of racial conflict. Bond mentions in his commencement speech "a group of activists whose current demands on the university will, hopefully, be expanded to include assaults on the very foundations of a society which has perverted education to reinforce inequity." In 1969, Black students presented eleven demands to university administration. In his commencement speech, Bond addressed some of these demands, as well as fueling the activist spirit. He said, "Why should we not have a black house on campus," directly mirroring student demands for a black dormitory on campus. Bond addressed the demands for a Black Studies program and for the inclusion of Black contributions in history classes when he asked, "Why should we not learn about ourselves the black students ask." The admittance of local Black students to the university was also addressed in Bond's speech. He claimed, "Why shouldn't any and every black high school graduate be admitted freely to the university, the black students ask."[44] Additionally, in his

[43]Julian Bond, *A Time to Speak, a Time to Act; the Movement in Politics*. (New York: Simon and Schuster, 1972).
[44]Commencement Address, Jan. 17, 1971, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 5. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan, p. 4-5.; "11 Black Demands," *Eastern Echo*, February 21, 1969.; Black Student Demands. Harold Sponberg Papers. Eastern Michigan University Archives.

speech Bond spoke about the role of the university, observing that it was still "an elitist, and largely a middle class white preserve in America."[45]

Eastern Michigan University received over 230 letters from Michigan residents protesting Julian Bond speaking at the January 17, 1971 commencement and receiving an honorary degree. Despite the people of Michigan branding Bond as a communist, an anarchist, anti-American, and a poor influence on youth, the University Honorary Degree Committee pursued the decision to host him as speaker and bestow him with an honorary Doctor of Laws. Bond's speech and appearance at Eastern Michigan occurred after the events of student protests on EMU's campus in February 1969 and in May 1970, and is inextricably linked to those protests. Forming the link between Bond's appearance on campus in 1971 and the student protests 1969 and 1970 using these letters of protests places Eastern Michigan University within the scope of the student protest movements of the 1960s and 1970s, and characterizes the relationship between the university and the community regarding local protests on campus.

[45]Commencement Address, Jan. 17, 1971, Commencement January 1971 Records, Box 1, Folder 5. Halle Library, Eastern Michigan University Archives, Ypsilanti, Michigan, p. 5.



Each point represents one letter sent to a member of the EMU Board of Regents or the University President in protest of Julian Bond speaking and receiving an honorary degree at the commencement ceremony on January 17, 1971. Every point also contains a quote from the letter sent in protest. The letters were all sent in January 1971 from EMU students and concerned Michigan citizens. Not included in each point is the date of the letter, nor are the categories each letter fell under for the purpose of this research. Only 217 of 237 letters could be mapped, as some of the letters did not include an address. Addresses for each letter are accurate to the city name; they are not exact addresses. Additionally marked on the map is Eastern Michigan University (marked with a green and white "E"), as well as the home cities of EMU Board of Regent members who received letters of protest at their home addresses (marked with a house).[46]

[46] Shelbie Torok, Julian Bond Letters of Protest (Province of Ontario: Esri, HERE, Garmin, FAO, NOAA, USGS, EPA, NPS, November 24, 2019), http://www.arcgis.com/home/webmap/viewer.html?webmap=1c2eab3282b04ad4b3cf268af7639545.

Appendix of Letters

A. H. Stedman II To Lawrence R. Husse
A. H. Stedman II To Dr. Charles Anspach
A. H. Stedman II To Virginia R. Allan
A. H. Stedman II To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Adrian Blauwkamp To Dr. Charles Anspach
Adrian Blauwkamp To Virginia R. Allan
Adrian Blauwkamp To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Adrian Blauwkamp To Dr. Charles Anspach
Adrian Blauwkamp To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Anna Kruis To Lawrence R. Husse
Anna Kruis To Dr. Charles Anspach
Anna Kruis To Virginia R. Allan
Anna Kruis To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Annie K. Blessed A.I.D. To Dr. Charles Anspach
Arthur C. Thede To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Arthur C. Thede To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Arthur R. Herez To Virginia R. Allan
Bernard Tschirhart To Lawrence R. Husse
Bernard Tschirhart To Dr. Charles Anspach
Bernard Tschirhart To Virginia R. Allan
Bernard Tschirhart To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Betsey To Virginia R. Allan
Blaire Gerould & Margaret Gerould To Virginia R. Allan
Blaire R. Gerould & Margaret A. Gerould To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Board of Directors, Kiwanis Club of Charlotte, Michigan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Board of Directors, Kiwanis Club of Charlotte, Michigan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Bona B. Bramble To Dr. Charles Anspach
Brent Bills To Dr. Charles Anspach
Brent Bills To Virginia Allan
Brent Bills To Dr. Charles Anspach
Carl Hoitenga To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Charlotte Kiwanis Club To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Claire R. Gerould & Margaret A. Gerould To Lawrence R. Husse
D. W. Hoppe To Lawrence R. Husse
D. W. Hoppe To *n/a*
Dawn Markus To Lawrence R. Husse
Dawn Markus To Dr. Charles Anspach
Dawn Markus To Virginia R. Allan

Dawn Markus To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Donald Duckihude To “Sir”
Doris L. Livingston & Alden Livingston To Dr. Charles Anspach
Doris L. Livingston & Alden Livingston To Virginia R. Allan
Doris L. & Alden Livingston To Dr. Harold Sponberg
E. Winfred Brown To Dr. Charles Anspach
E. Winfred Brown To Virginia R. Allan
E. Winfred Brown To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Edward Regenten To Dr. Charles Anspach
Edward Regenten To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Elizabeth F. Bontekoe To Dr. Charles Anspach
Elizabeth F. Bontekoe To Virginia Allan
Elizabeth F. Bontekoe To Dr. Charles Anspach
Elizabeth Olstrike To Dr. Charles Anspach
Elizabeth Olstrike To Virginia R. Allan
Elizabeth Olstrike To Dr. Charles Anspach
Elizabeth Olstrike To Dr. Harold Sponberg
F. Gerrit Celdman & Milo Newer To Dr. Charles Anspach
F. Lawrence Badgley To Edward McCormick
Frances Waymaster To *n/a*
Frances Waymaster To *n/a*
Frances Waymaster & Albert Waymaster To *n/a*
Frank A. Lane To Dr. Charles Anspach
Frank A. Lane To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Gailen Byrd To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Gary Byker To Dr. Charles Anspach
Gerald S. Nowicki To Lawrence R. Husse
Gerald S. Nowicki To Dr. Charles Anspach
Gerald S. Nowicki To Virginia R. Allan
Gerald S. Nowicki To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Gilbert R. Gregory To Lawrence R. Husse
Gilbert R. Gregory To Dr. Charles Anspach
Gilbert R. Gregory To Virginia R. Allan
Gilbert R. Gregory To Virginia R. Allan
Gilbert R. Gregory To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Gilbert R. Gregory To Dr. Harold Sponberg
H. R. Gorz To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Harmon Cropsey To “Clerk”
Harmon Cropsey To Dr. Charles Anspach

Harmon Cropsey To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Harmon Cropsey To *n/a*
Hayes GaniardTo Virginia R. Allan
Hayes Ganiard To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Helen V. Bailey To Lawrence R. Husse
Helen V. Bailey To Virginia R. Allan
Helen V. Bailey To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Board of Directors, Kiwanis Club of Charlotte, Michigan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Board of Directors, Kiwanis Club of Charlotte, Michigan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Board of Directors, Kiwanis Club of Charlotte, Michigan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Board of Directors, Kiwanis Club of Charlotte, Michigan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
J. F. Kennedy To Dr. Charles Anspach
James D. Burke To Dr. Charles Anspach
James Potrude To Dr. Charles Anspach
James Potrude To Virginia R. Allan
James Potrude To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Jeane B. Poole To Virginia R. Allan
Kenneth Beardslee To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Lawrence Badgley To Dr. Charles Anspach
Lawrence Badgley To Virginia R. Allan
Lawrence Badgley To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Leona Wambach To Lawrence R. Husse
Leona Wambach To *n/a*
Leonard & Arline Learst To Lawrence R. Husse
Leonard & Arline Learst To Virginia R. Allan
Leonard & Arline Learst To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Leonard & Arline Learst To Dr. Charles Anspach
Leonard Brandt To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Leonard Learst To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Leonard R. Schultz To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Leonard R. Schultz To Virginia R. Allan
Leonard R. Schultz To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Luther R. Dunard To Virginia Allan
Luther R. Dunard To Dr. Charles Anspach
M. Nichols To Lawrence R. Husse
M. Nichols To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Marjorie Jacobson To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Marjorie P. Jacobson To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Marjorie P. Jacobson To Dr. Harold Sponberg

Mary C. Brehob & Norman M. Brehob To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mary C. Brehob, Norman M. Brehob To Lawrence R. Husse
Mary Nichols To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mary Nichols To Virginia R. Allan
Matthew J. Scheech To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Maurice Grove To Dr. Charles Anspach
Maurice Grove To Virginia R. Allan
Maurice Grove To Dr. Charles Anspach
Maurice Grove To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Max Michmirhinze To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Michael R. Stimac To Lawrence R. Husse
Michael R. Struiss To Virginia R. Allan
Michael R. Struiss To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Miss Lois Boyd To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mr. & Mrs. Arthur C. Thede To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mr. & Mrs. Arthur C. Thede To Virginia R. Allan
Mr. & Mrs. C. Hoffmann To Lawrence R. Husse
Mr. & Mrs. C. Hoffmann To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mr. & Mrs. C. Hoffmann To Virginia R. Allan
Mr. & Mrs. C. Hoffmann To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mr. & Mrs. Edward Kendziowski To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mr. & Mrs. Lloyd Schpolin, Mr. & Mrs. Richard E. Hall, Dr. & Mrs. Earl G. Brook, Mr. & Mrs. George Boyle, Mr. & Mrs. Bryan M. Armbruster, Mr. & Mrs. A. Frieseu, Dr. & Mrs. H. P. Book, Miss Dikkie Ruth To “Friends”
Mr. & Mrs. Lloyd Schpolin, Mr. & Mrs. Richard E. Hall, Dr. & Mrs. Earl G. Brook, Mr. & Mrs. George Boyle, Mr. & Mrs. Bryan M. Armbruster, Mr. & Mrs. A. Frieseu, Dr. & Mrs. H. P. Book, Miss Dikkie Ruth To “Friends”
Mr. & Mrs. Lloyd Schpolin, Mr. & Mrs. Richard E. Hall, Dr. & Mrs. Earl G. Brook, Mr. & Mrs. George Boyle, Mr. & Mrs. Bryan M. Armbruster, Mr. & Mrs. A. Frieseu, Dr. & Mrs. H. P. Book, Miss Dikkie Ruth To “Friends”
Mr. & Mrs. Lloyd Schpolin, Mr. & Mrs. Richard E. Hall, Dr. & Mrs. Earl G. Brook, Mr. & Mrs. George Boyle, Mr. & Mrs. Bryan M. Armbruster, Mr. & Mrs. A. Frieseu, Dr. & Mrs. H. P. Book, Miss Dikkie Ruth To “Friends”
Mr. & Mrs. T. W. Kitchen To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mr. Donald Hoppe To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mr. Leroy L. Cowell To “Sir”
Mrs. A. M. Bierman To Lawrence R. Husse
Mrs. A. M. Bierman To Virginia R. Allan
Mrs. A. M. Bierman To Dr. Harold Sponberg

Mrs. Bona B. Bramble To President & Board of Regents
Mrs. Dale McAllister To Lawrence R. Husse
Mrs. Dale McAllister To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Dennis H. Poole To Lawrence R. Husse
Mrs. Dennis H. Poole To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Earl Poindexter To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. F. J. Mascio To Lawrence R. Husse
Mrs. F. J. Mascio To Virginia R. Allan
Mrs. F. J. Mascio To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. James Lill To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. L. Beauchamp To Lawrence R. Husse
Mrs. L. Beauchamp To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. L. O. To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Leona Wambach To Virginia R. Allan
Mrs. Leona Wambach To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. N Black To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. N. A. To "Sir"
Mrs. N. Black To Virginia Allan
Mrs. N. Black To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. N. Black To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Oliphant To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. Phyllis Black To Virginia Allan
Mrs. Phyllis Black To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Phyllis Burke & Mr. James D. Burke To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. Ralph Mahan To "The President & all members of the Board of Regents"
Mrs. Ralph Mahan To "The President & all members of the Board of Regents"
Mrs. Ralph Mahan To "The President & all members of the Board of Regents"
Mrs. Ralph Mahan To "The President & all members of the Board of Regents"
Mrs. Rose Davis To "Sir"
Mrs. Serval R. Allen To Virginia R. Allan
Mrs. Serval R. Allen To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Serval R. Allen (an alumni) To Dr. Charles Anspach
Mrs. Shirley Sroka To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Sylvia Mattoon To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Mrs. Wm. N. Lydia Love To Virginia R. Allan
Myles Laughrin To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Nancy E. Cummings To Lawrence R. Husse
Nancy E. Cummings To Dr. Charles Anspach
Nancy E. Cummings To Virginia R. Allan

Nancy E. Cummings To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Norman M. Brehob & Mary C. Brehob To Virginia R. Allan
Norman M. Brehob & Mary C. Brehob To Dr. Harold Sponberg
P. H. MacBride To Dr. Charles Anspach
P. H. MacBride To Virginia R. Allan
P. H. MacBride To Dr. Charles Anspach
Patricia Neenan To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Paul Filiatrault To Lawrence R. Husse
Paul Neenan To Virginia R. Allan
Paul Neenan To Dr. Charles Anspach
Paul Neenen To Lawrence R. Husse
Phyllis B. Korten To Lawrence R. Husse
Phyllis B. Korten To Dr. Charles Anspach
Phyllis B. Korten To Virginia R. Allan
Phyllis B. Korten To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Richard & Marian Carpenter To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Richard & Marien Carpenter To Virginia R. Allan
Richard Friske To Lawrence R. Husse
Richard Friske To Dr. Charles Anspach
Richard Friske To Virginia R. Allan
Richard Friske To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Richard H. Ichord To Virginia R. Allan
Richard H. Smith, Jr. To Lawrence R. Husse
Richard R. Smith To Virginia R. Allan
Richard R. Smith To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Robert L. Harrison & C. E. Schumacher To Dr. Charles Anspach
Robert L. Harrison & C. E. Schumacher To Virginia R. Allan
Robert L. Harrison & C. E. Schumacher To Dr. Richard N. Robb
Robert L. Harrison & C. E. Schumacher To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Robert L. Harrison & C. E. Schumacher To Lawrence R. Husse
S. G. Youngert To Virginia R. Allan
Sarah M. Hellworth To “Regent of EMU”
Sarah M. Hellworth To Virginia R. Allan
Sarah M. Hillworth To “Regent of EMU”
Sherly Sroka To Dr. Charles Anspach
Shirley Sroka To Virginia R. Allan
Shirley Sroka To Virginia R. Allan
T. H. Drury To *n/a*
F Gerrit Veldman & Milo Newer To Lawrence R. Husse

F Gerrit Veldman & Millo Newer To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Thea G. Stewart To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Virginia R. Allen To Dr. Harold Sponberg
W. Bowerman To Dr. Harold Sponberg
W. H. DeMattia To Dr. Harold Sponberg
W. H. DeMattia To Dr. Harold Sponberg
W. H. DeMattia To Dr. Harold Sponberg
Wainer Remmington To Lawrence R. Husse
Wainer Remington To Dr. Charles Anspach
Wainer Remington To Virginia R. Allan
Wainer Remington To Dr. Harold Sponberg
William Hefnagel, Matilda Hefnagel, William L. Hefnagel To Dr. Harold Sponberg
William Olstrike To Dr. Harold Sponberg
William R. Bennett To Lawrence R. Husse

Bibliography

Primary Sources

Manuscript Collections

Eastern Michigan University Archives, Halle Library, Ypsilanti, Michigan

Campus Demonstration Records
- Mass Disturbance Policy, 1970 - 1971
- Report of the Commission to Investigate the Disorders at Eastern Michigan University, 1970 - 1970
- Student Deliberations Committee Meeting Minutes, 1970 - 1970

Commencement January 1971 Records
- Letters of Protest, 1970-1971
- Julian Bond Commencement Address, 1971 January 17
- University's Response to Protest Letters

Faculty Council Records
- Honorary Degrees

Harold E. Sponberg papers
- Demonstration
- Demonstrations on Campus

Newspapers & Periodicals

Eastern Echo

Detroit Free Press

The New York Times

Secondary Sources

Altbach, Philip G. "Introduction: Student Activism in the Seventies." *Higher Education* 8, no. 6 (1979): 603–7.

Biondi, Martha. *The Black Revolution on Campus*. Berkley and Los Angeles: University of California Press, 2012.

Bond, Julian. *A Time to Speak, a Time to Act; the Movement in Politics.* New York: Simon and Schuster, 1972.

Cohen, Robert, and David J. Snyder, eds. *Rebellion in Black and White*. Baltimore, Maryland: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 2013.

Dyke, Nella van. "Hotbeds of Activism: Locations of Student Protest." *Social Problems* 45, no. 2 (1998): 205–20. https://doi.org/10.2307/3097244.

Fendrich, James M., and Charles U. Smith. "Black Activists: Ten Years Later." *The Journal of Negro Education* 49, no. 1 (1980): 3–19. https://doi.org/10.2307/2294778.

SNCC Digital Gateway. "Founding of SNCC." Accessed November 23, 2019. https://snccdigital.org/events/founding-of-sncc/.

Hogan, Wesley. "How Democracy Travels: SNCC, Swarthmore Students, and the Growth of the Student Movement in the North, 1961-1964." *The Pennsylvania Magazine of History and Biography* 126, no. 3 (2002): 437–70.

Horowitz, Helen Lefkowitz. "The 1960s and the Transformation of Campus Cultures." *History of Education Quarterly* 26, no. 1 (1986): 1–38. https://doi.org/10.2307/368875.

Levine, Arthur, and Keith R. Wilson. "Student Activism in the 1970s: Transformation Not Decline." *Higher Education* 8, no. 6 (1979): 627–40.

Morgan, Demetri L., and Charles H. F. Davis III, eds. *Student Activism, Politics, and Campus Climate in Higher Education*. New York: Taylor & Francis, 2019.

Roche, Jeff. "Political Conservatism in the Sixties: Silent Majority or White Backlash?" In *The Columbia Guide to America in the 1960s*, edited by David Farber and Beth Bailey. Columbia University Press, 2001.

Torok, Shelbie. “Julian Bond Letters of Protest.” Province of Ontario: Esri, HERE, Garmin, FAO, NOAA, USGS, EPA, NPS, 2019. http://www.arcgis.com/home/webmap/viewer.html?webmap=1c2eab3282b04ad4b3cf268af7639545.

Turner, Jeffrey A. *Sitting in and Speaking Out*. Athens, Georgia: University of Georgia Press, 2010.